



MODI (RIGHT) WITH SHAH AFTER BEING ELECTED GCA PRESIDENT

AHMEDABAD | Hitting a Double Ton

After wrenching four Assembly seats from the Congress in the recent byelections, Narendra Modi has established that the BJP is no walkover—at least not on his watch. The BJP walked away with five of the seven contested seats. Modi instantly predicted that Gujarat was a “trailer” of what was going to happen in the “Maharashtra polls”. The chief minister then pulled off a double whammy, taking charge of the Gujarat Cricket Association (GCA) after being elected its president at its annual general meeting. Until now, the post had been firmly held by Congress leader Narhari Amin. Modi’s Home Minister Amit Shah had been fighting a long-drawn political and legal battle for a year-and-a-half against Amin to gain control of the GCA, and many believed it was Shah who would take over. But his boss now joins fellow political heavyweights in the Board. He will keep the company of former BCCI chief Sharad Pawar, who remains influential and involved as the president of the Mumbai Cricket Association and also BJP leader Arun Jaitley, president of the Delhi and District Cricket Association. During the Assembly bypolls, Modi had kept away from his usual acerbic poll rhetoric. Some even attribute the Assembly win to the Congress tirade against him over the Ishrat Jahan case. For Modi, his second innings seems to have just begun.

by Uday Mahurkar

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Assembly seats out of seven were won by the BJP in the recent bypolls. In the Lok Sabha polls, the BJP won 15 of the 26 seats.